SOP-UC-001: Unity Catalog Data Access (Catalog / Schema / Table / View / Function / Volume)

Owner: MLOps Platform Team | Version 1.0 | Sample SOP for prototype

1. Purpose and Scope

- This SOP covers granting or revoking access to Unity Catalog securables in Databricks: catalogs, schemas, tables, views, SQL functions (UDFs) and volumes.
- Typical privileges: USE CATALOG, USE SCHEMA, SELECT, MODIFY, EXECUTE, READ VOLUME, WRITE VOLUME.

2. When to use this SOP

- A user or AD group needs read (SELECT) or write (MODIFY) access to a table, view or schema.
- A user or AD group needs EXECUTE permission on a SQL function or UDF.
- Access to data in a lakehouse data product needs to be added, changed or removed.

3. Not covered by this SOP

- Access to registered ML models or model serving endpoints: use SOP-MDL-004.

4. Required information in the ticket

- Environment (dev, uat, prod).
- Principal type and name. Grants must go to an AD group; individual-user grants need DPO exception.
- Fully qualified securable name: catalog.schema.object.
- Privilege requested and data product name.
- Business justification and access duration.

5. Validation rules

- Securable must exist in the target environment.
- Privilege must be the least required; ALL PRIVILEGES and MANAGE are never granted via ticket.
- Prod MODIFY requires an additional JO sign-off.
- PII-tagged tables require the requester group to be on the PII-approved list.

6. Approval

- Data Product Owner (DPO) of the owning data product approves every grant.
- Job Owner (JO) approval is additionally required for prod write access.

7. Implementation

- Repository: lakehouse-policies.
- Branch: feature/-uc-access created from dev.
- File: policies///.yaml. Add the principal and privilege under the securable's grants block.

8. Deployment

- Jenkins job: lakehouse-policies-deploy-, triggered after the PR is merged to dev (non-prod) or main (prod).

9. Post-deployment verification

- Run SHOW GRANTS ON in the target workspace and confirm the principal and privilege.
- Comment the result on the ASPEN ticket and resolve it.